

Fate System Design Notes

Core Philosophy

Fate is not a power-up.

Fate is a decision.

When the player sees the Fate block, they should hesitate and ask:

"Should I?"

Ignoring Fate should feel safe.

Taking Fate should feel exciting.

Neither choice should be obviously correct.

Design Philosophy

The player chooses to interact with Fate.

The player does NOT choose the outcome.

Fate represents events outside the player's control.

The goal is not fairness.

The goal is memorable moments.

Players should tell stories about Fate.

Programming Structure

Use programmer-friendly names in code.

Examples:

`clear_board()`

`spawn_bad_blocks()`

trigger_red_combo()

add_time()

freeze_player()

Use separate display names for players.

Examples:

THE HANGED MAN

THE TOWER

THE DEVIL

FORTUNE

TEMPERANCE

The display names can change later without affecting the code.

Possible Fate Effects

Board Effects

- Destroy 1–6 random bad blocks
 - Spawn 1–6 bad blocks
 - Clear entire board
 - Destroy every block of one color
 - Destroy every block
 - Place an X explosion somewhere on the board
 - Shrink board
 - Grow board
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Combo Effects

- Trigger Red combo
- Trigger Blue combo
- Trigger Green combo
- Trigger Yellow combo
- Trigger every combo
- Trigger a random combo

Timer Effects

- Add 0.5 seconds
- Remove 0.5 seconds
- Double timer
- Cut timer in half

Player Effects

- Freeze player briefly
- Reverse controls
- Wrong button presses spawn blocks
- Disable movement briefly
- Speed player up
- Slow player down

Chaos Effects

- Every destroy spawns a block for 1 second
- Every destroy clears an extra block
- Random blocks change color
- Player block teleports
- Bad blocks teleport
- Spawn another Fate block
- Fate activates twice

Design Goal

The player should never know exactly what Fate will do.

The important moment is not the effect itself.

The important moment is the split second where the player asks:

"Should I risk it?"

If players tell stories about Fate after playing, the system has succeeded.